

plex relationship with their finances. For most of my adult life, I had genuinely assumed that the secret to being ‘good with money’ was something that everyone else had been imbibed with from an early age, that I was uniquely terrible at being an adult. Once I started talking about it, first in an anonymous confession on the internet, then more intimately with friends and family, I started to recognize the plethora of different ways in which a person can struggle with money, and just how common it is to do so.

The five steps

You might be asking how, after these last few pages, it’s possible to narrow something so utterly enormous and complex as financial wellbeing down to five steps, and that is definitely a legitimate question. All of the themes and issues that we will cover here will bear further reflection and introspection, but these steps outline a framework that I believe to be fairly universal – one that I hope will make you feel included, supported and maybe even a little bit inspired. That is not to say that this is an exhaustive account of the actions that need to be taken to achieve a full sense of financial wellbeing, or a peaceful relationship with money, or that you will finish reading it and be ‘fixed’. Like all good (I hope) personal development books, it needs to allow space for you to develop your own ideas and strategies for achieving this. If part of the problem with mainstream financial narratives is that they are too prescriptive, I certainly don’t want to be complicit in that.